

Computer Organisation

Topic 1

Introduction

(Part 1)

Outline

- History of computers
- X86, PowerPC and ARM evolution

Organisation
and
architecture

Structure and
function

Computer
evolution and
performance

Cloud
Computing

Performance
Issues

Architecture & Organisation

- **Architecture** is those attributes **visible** to the programmer (programmer's view of a computer)
- It is defined by the instruction set
- (language), and operand locations (registers and memory).
 - Deals with the functional behaviour of a computer system
 - Attributes: a system that has a direct impact on the **logical execution of a program**
 - It defines the system in an abstract manner
 - It deals with What does the system do
 - Instruction set, number of bits used for data representation, I/O mechanisms, addressing techniques
 - e.g. Is there a multiply instruction?

Architecture & Organisation

• **Organization** is how features are **implemented**

- Deals with structural relationship
- Attributes: **hardware details** transparent to the programmer
- Is the way in which a system must structure and its operational units and the interconnections between them that achieve the architectural specifications
- It is the realization of the abstract model
- It deals with How to implement the system
- Control signals, interfaces between the computer and peripherals, memory technology
- e.g. Is there a hardware multiply unit or is it done by repeated addition?

Architecture & Organisation

Computer architecture is about "**what**" a computer system does, while computer organization is about "**how**" it does it. Architecture defines the capabilities and features, while organization determines how those features are implemented in hardware.

- A systematic approach of deriving the solution of any problem
- Manufacturers produce **family** of computer models
 - **Same architecture, different organisation**
 - Different models = different price and performance

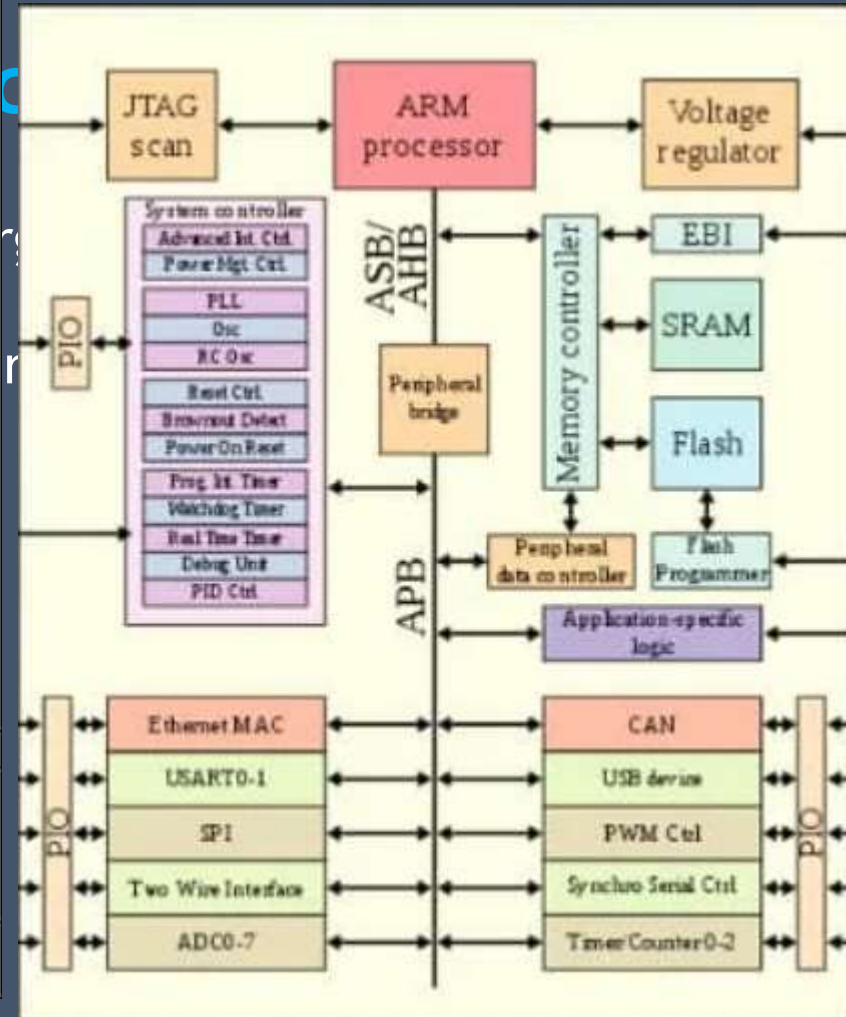
Architecture & Organisation

- All **Intel x86 family** share the same basic architecture
- Similarly **ARM Cortex-M, R and A families** have the same respective ARMv7-M, R and A architectures

x86 PROCESSORS (from Intel)

		Clock Speed (approx.)	Bus Size (bits)	Max RAM	Storage Range	OS	
Bits	Family						
64	Xeon	4.5GHz	64	3TB	500GB-10TB	Windows: 11, 10, 8, 7 XP, 2000 NT, 98 95, 3.x	
	Core i9	5.8GHz		128GB			
	Core i3, i5, i7	3.3GHz		64GB			
	Core 2 Duo	2.6GHz					
	Pentium 4	3.8GHz					
	Pentium D	3.4GHz					
32	Core Duo	2.2GHz		64	4GB	500MB-60GB	Linux Mac OS X SCO Unix Solaris
	Pentium 4	2.8GHz					
	Xeon	3.2GHz					
	Celeron	2.4GHz					
	Pentium III	1.2GHz					
	Pentium II	450MHz					
	Pentium Pro	233MHz	32	64GB	200 - 500MB 60 - 200MB	DOS DR DOS OS/2 Misc DOS Multiuser	
	Pentium	200MHz					
	486DX	100MHz					
	486SX	40MHz					
	386DX	40MHz					
	386SX	33MHz					
386SL	25MHz						
16	286	12MHz	16	16MB	20-80MB	DOS DR DOS Win 3.x OS/2 1.x	
	8086	10MHz		1MB	10-20MB	DOS DR DOS	
	8088	5MHz	8				

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Structure & Function

- A computer is a **complex** system
 - A **hierarchical** system is a set of interrelated **subsystems**
 - At each level, look into the components and their **interrelationships**

Structure & Function

- **Structure** is the way in which **components relate** to each other
- **Function** is the **operation** of the individual component as part of the structure

Structure & Function

- In terms of description, we have two choices:

Bottom-up

Starting at the bottom
and building up to a
complete description

Top-down

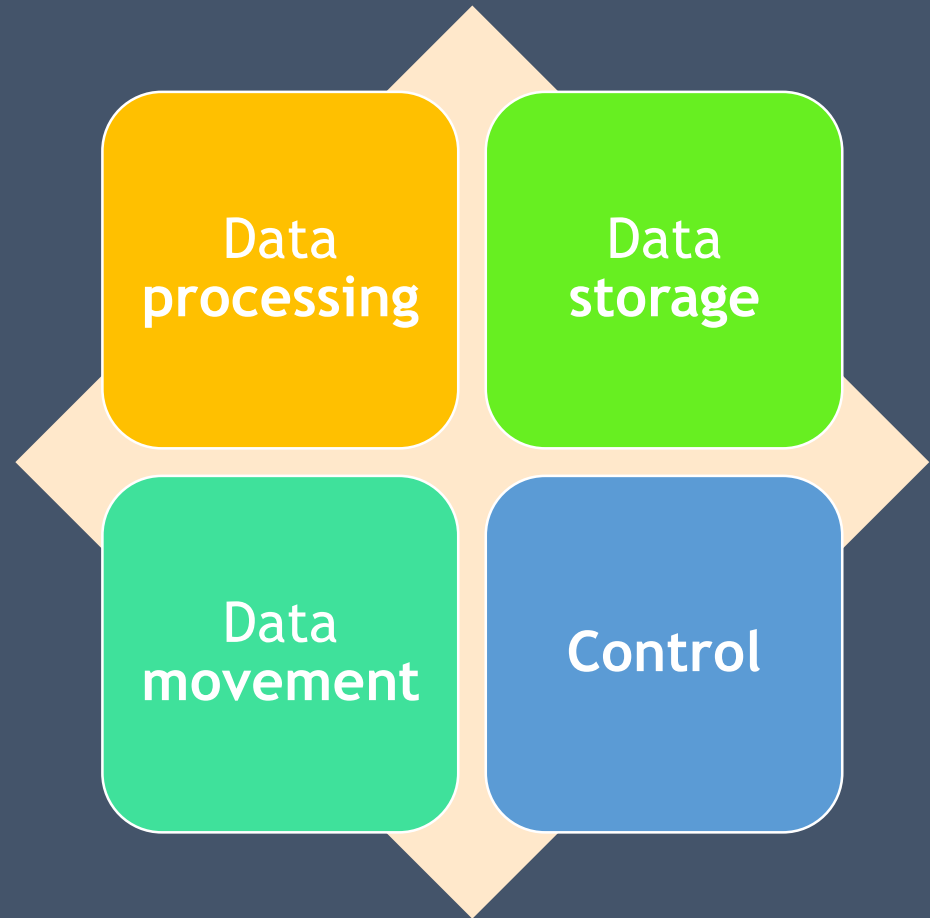
Beginning with a top
view and decomposing
the system into its
subparts

Structure & Function

- Clearer to describe computer system using **top-down** approach
 - start with major components (their structure & function)
 - proceed to the lower layer

Function

All computer functions are:



Function

All computer functions are:

Data processing

- Data may take a wide variety of forms and different processing requirements

Data storage

- Even though the computer process the data on the fly, the computer must temporarily store at least those pieces of data
- Short term vs long term data storage

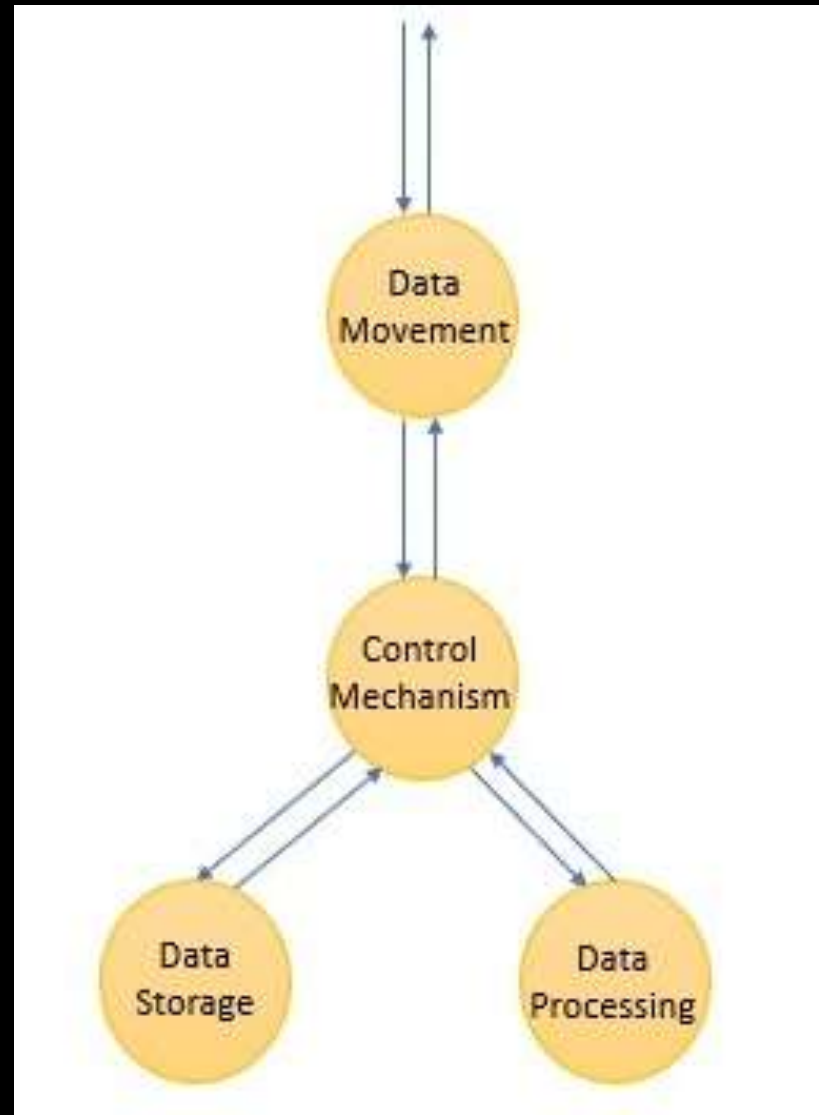
Data movement

- Input-output (I/O)
Peripheral

Control

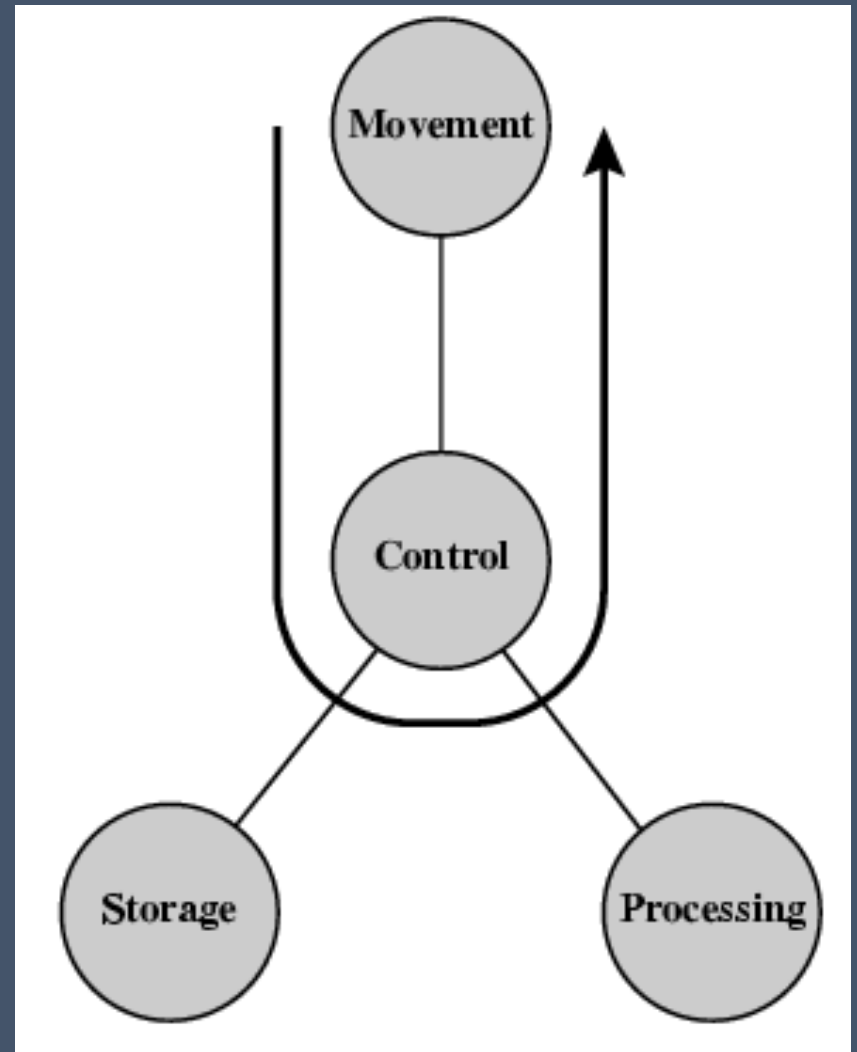
- Manages the computer resources

Functional View



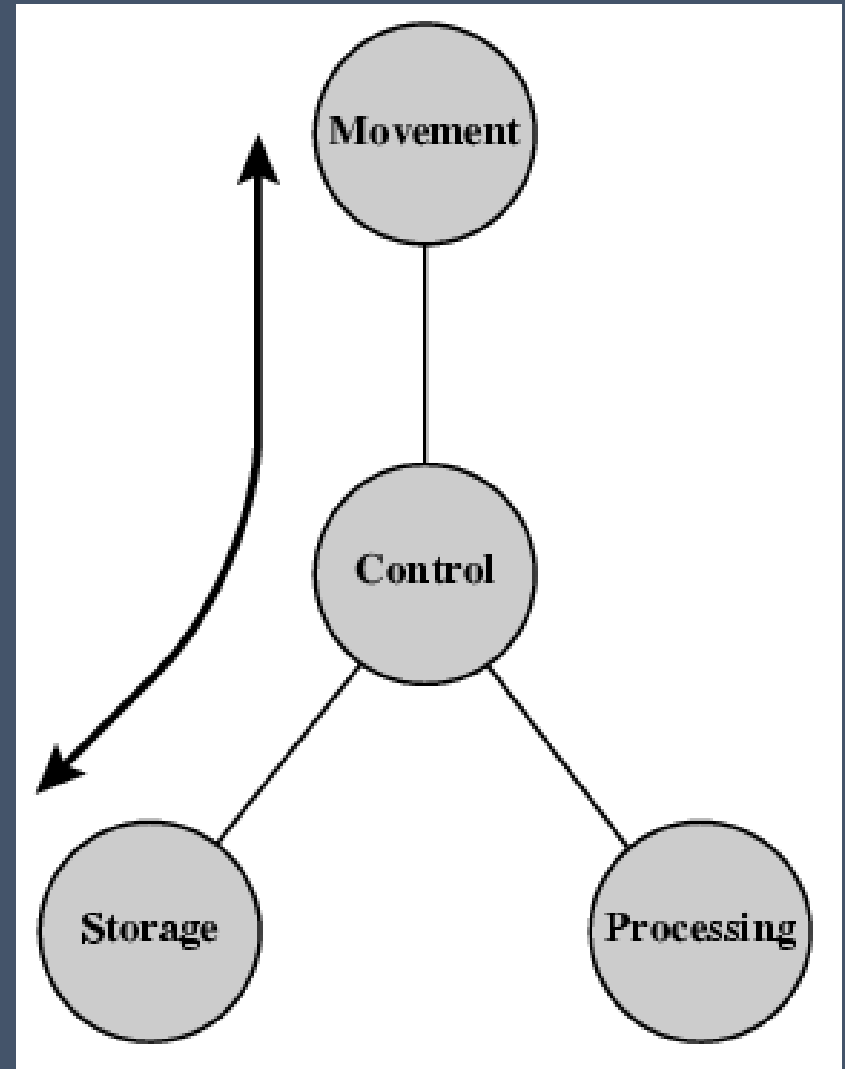
Operations

(a) Data movement

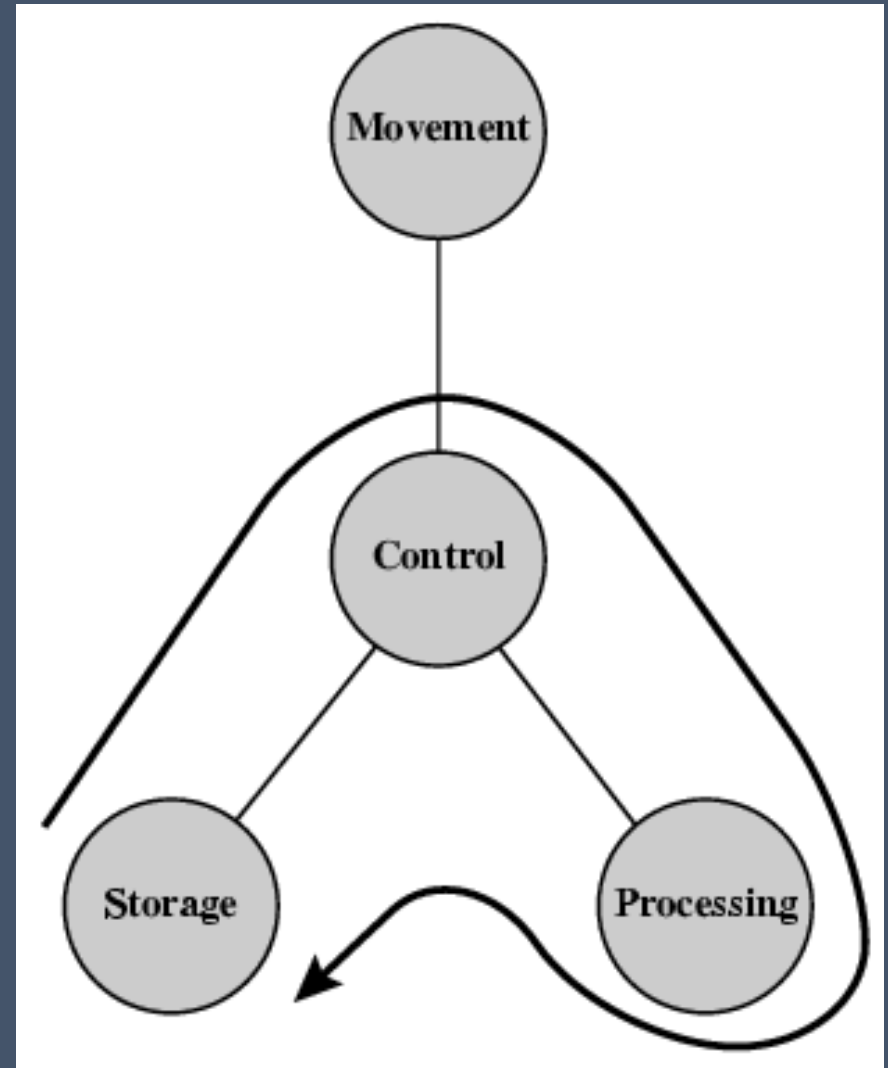


Operations

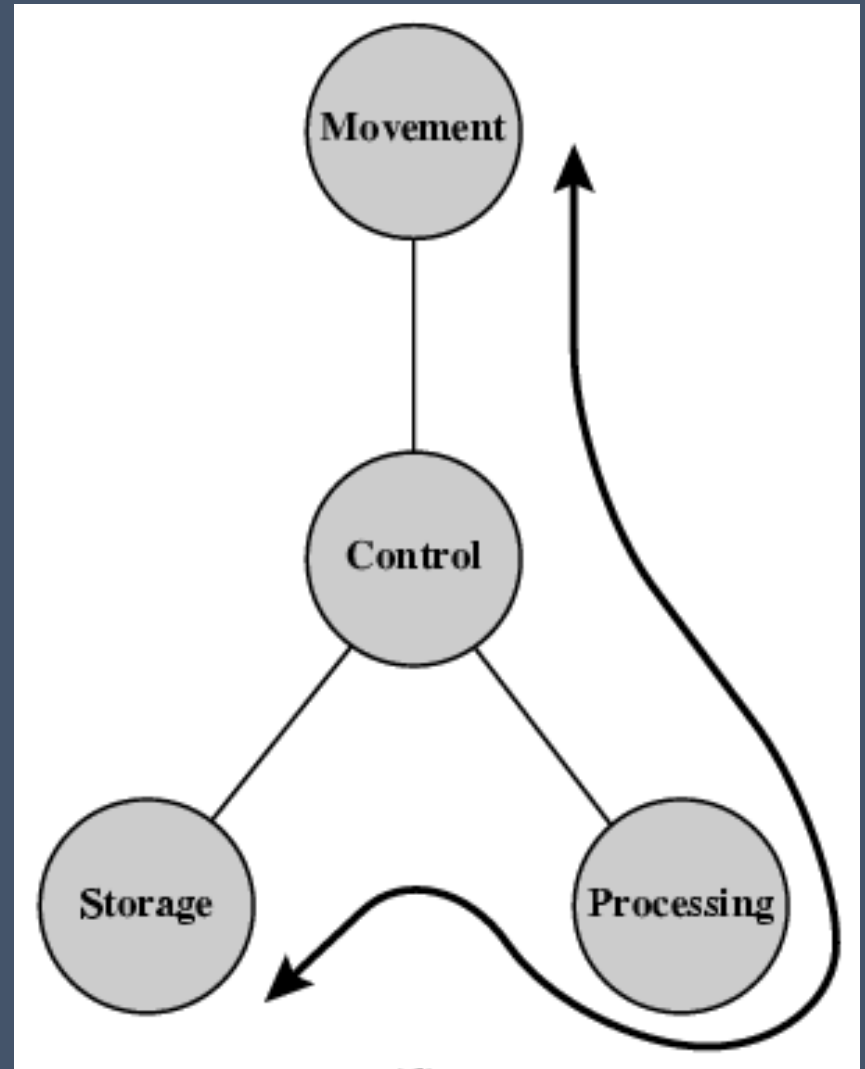
(b) **Storage**



Operation
(c) **Processing**
from/to storage

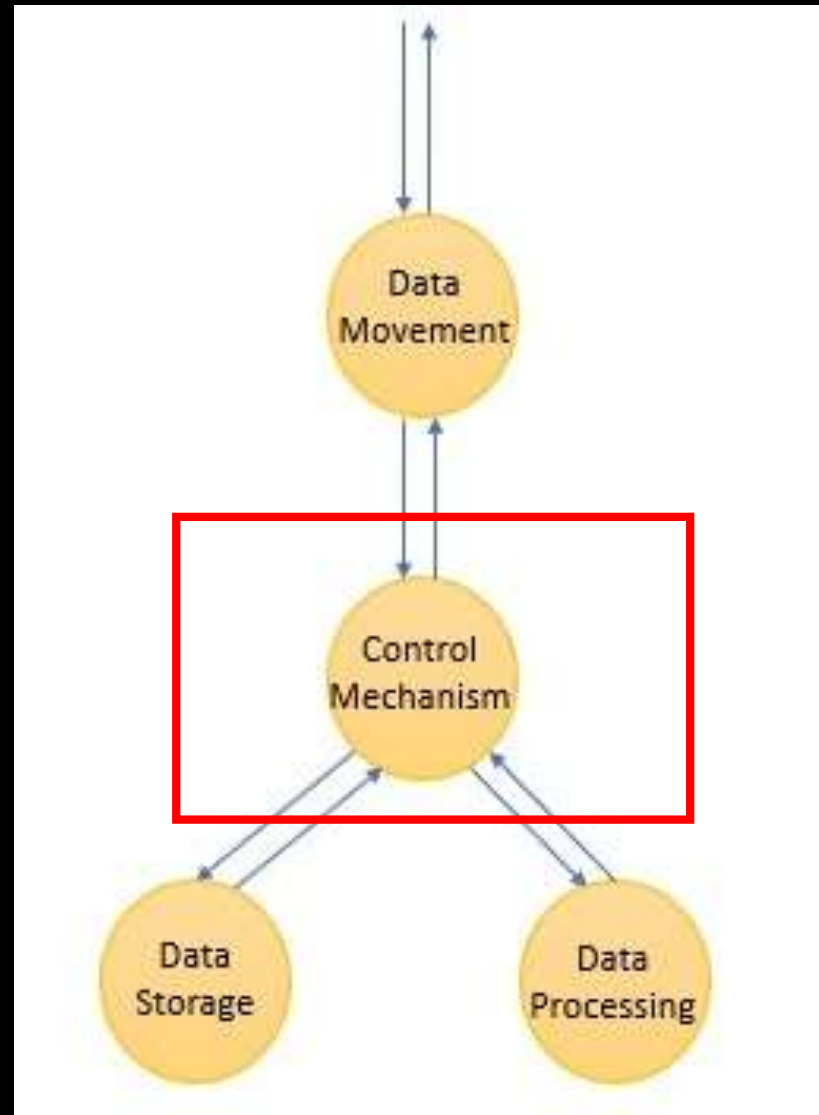


Operation
(d) **Processing** from
storage to I/O



Control

a unit that would control and synchronize the function of these units



Function

- Data processing
- Data storage
- Data movement
- Control

• Which is the most important?



Function

- Data processing
- Data storage
- Data movement
- Control



- Which is the “busiest”?

Function

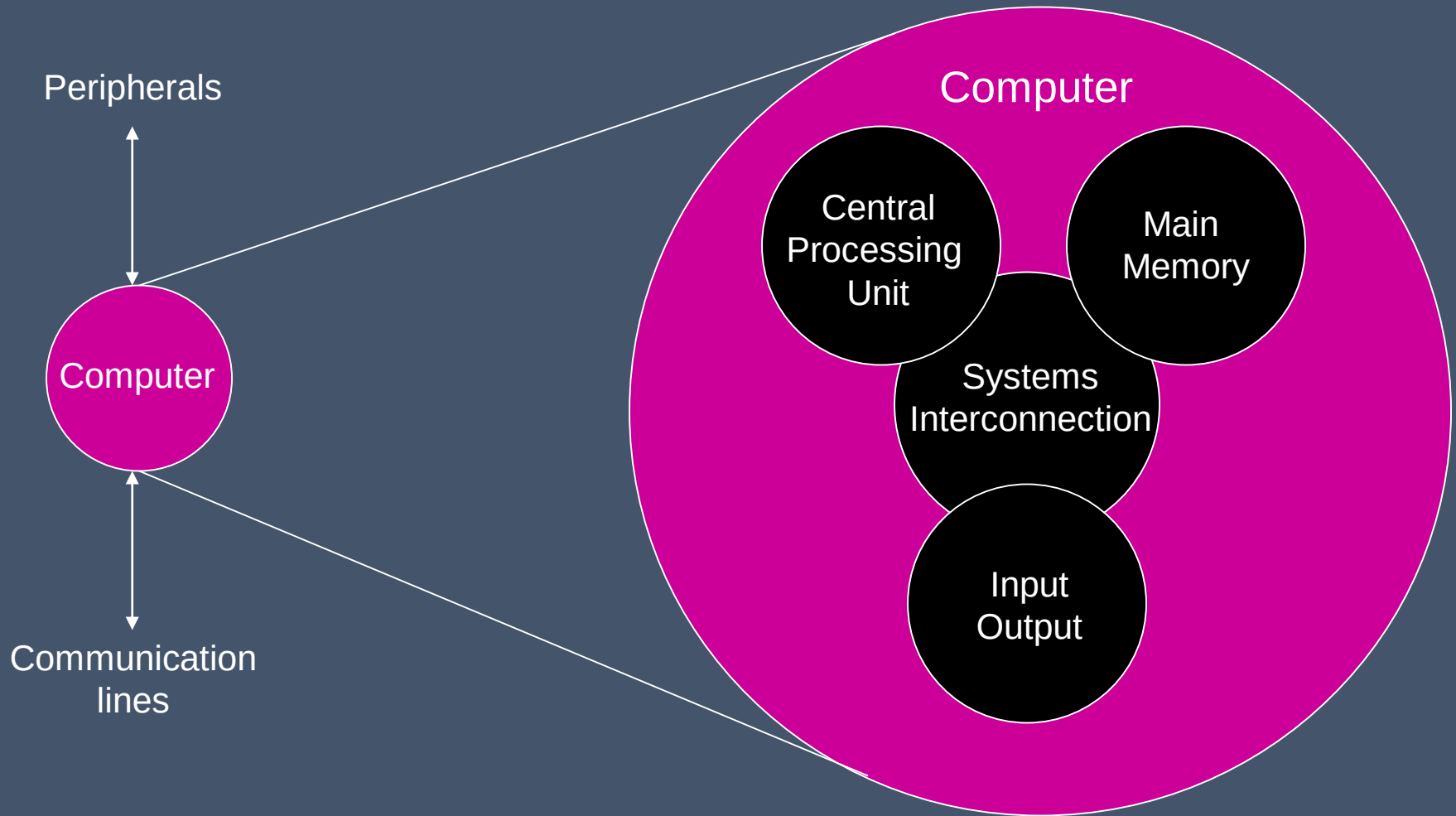
- Data processing
- Data storage
- Data movement
- Control

• So, which is the most important? 😊

Structure

- Internal structure of a computer:
- 4 main components
 - **Central processing unit** (or processor)
 - controls the operation and performs data processing
 - **Main memory**
 - stores data
 - **I/O**
 - moves data between the computer and its external environment
 - **System interconnection**
 - mechanism for communication among CPU, main memory and I/O

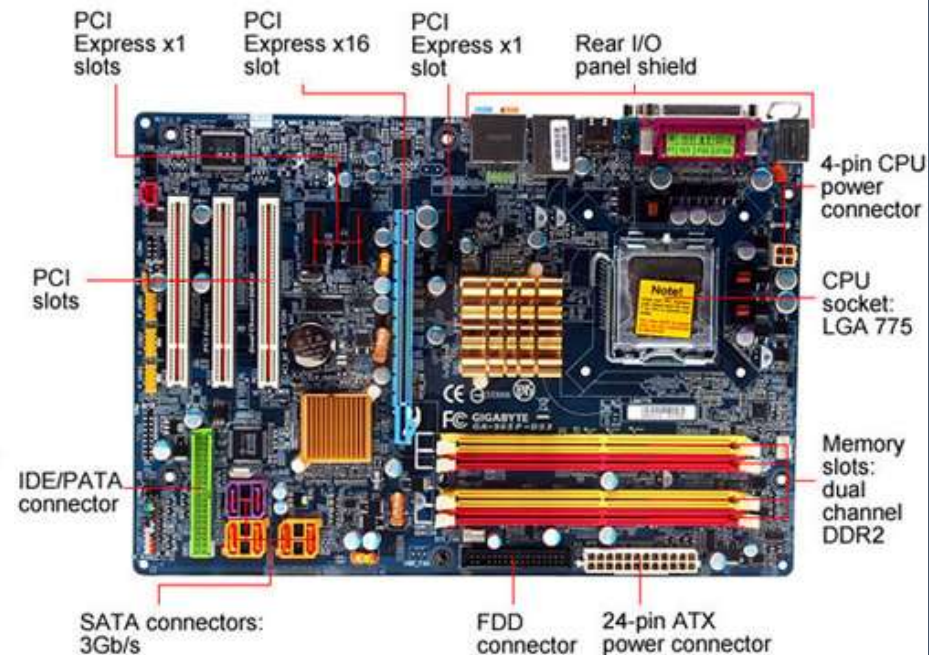
Structure Top Level



Structure Top Level (Hardware)

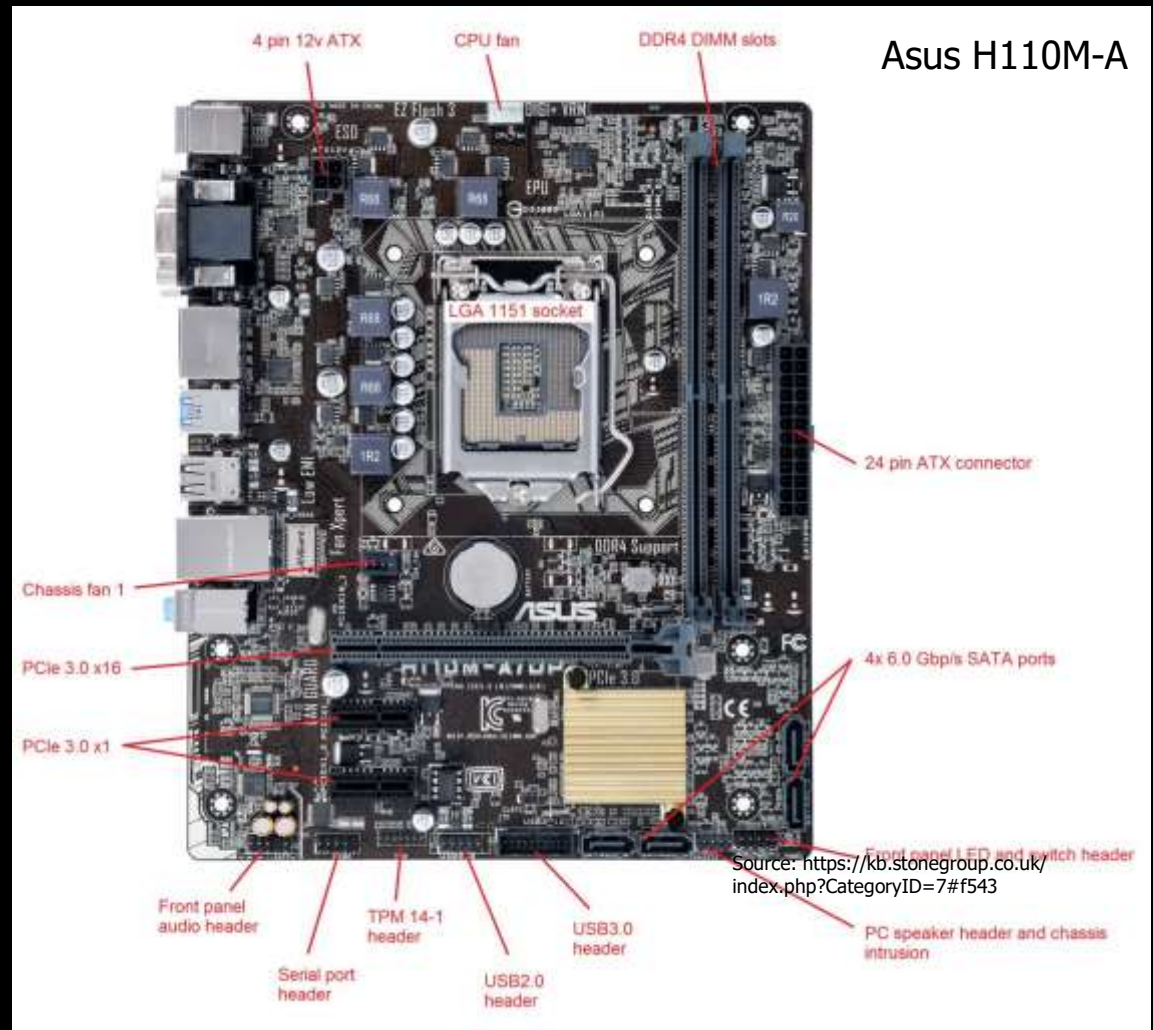


Source: https://www.123rf.com/photo_9645973_black-stylish-desktop-pc-isolated-on-white-background.html



Source: https://www.legitreviews.com/gigabyte-ga-965p-ds3-motherboard-review_418

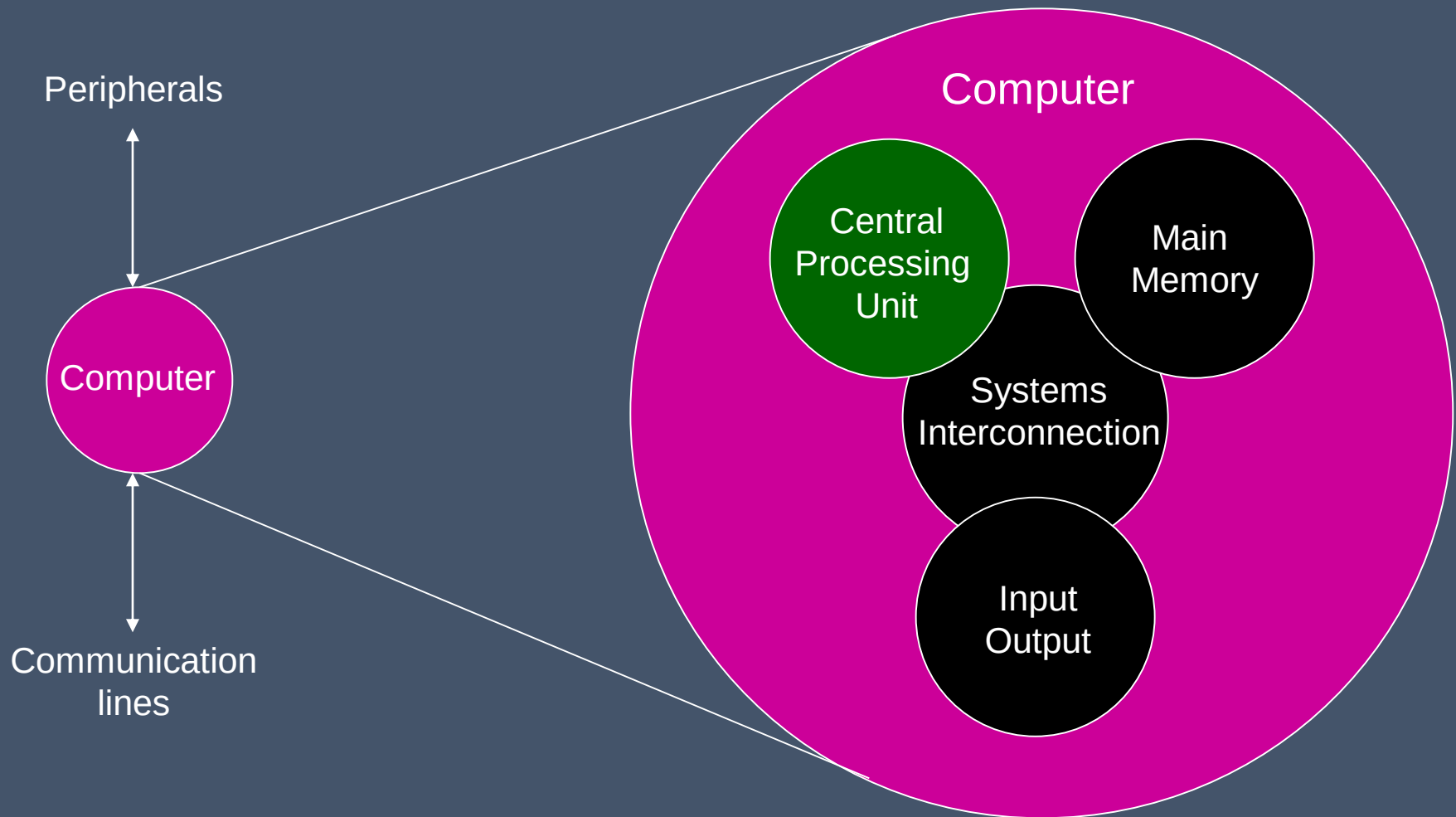
Structure Top Level (Hardware)



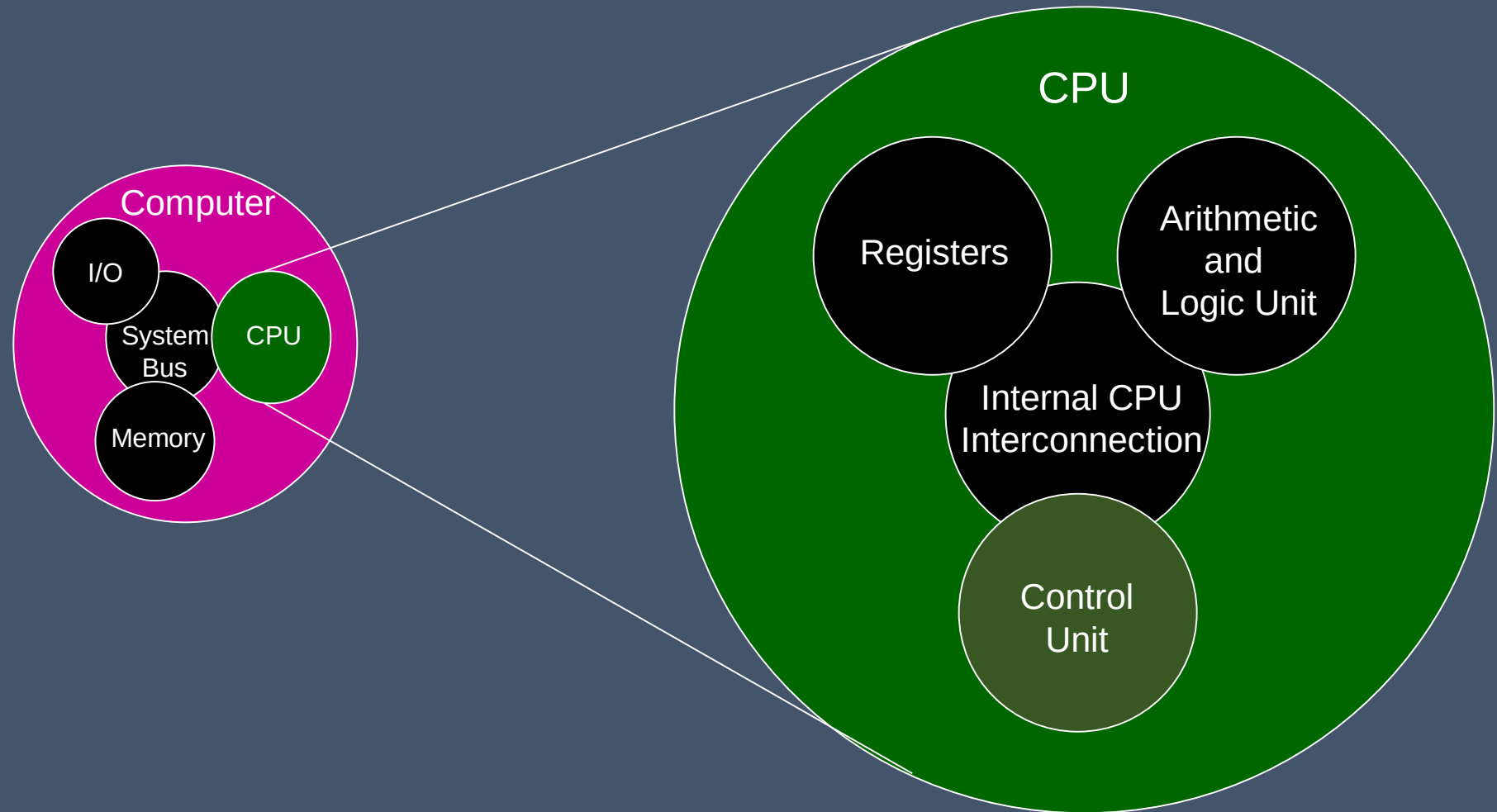
Structure Top Level (Hardware)



Structure Top Level

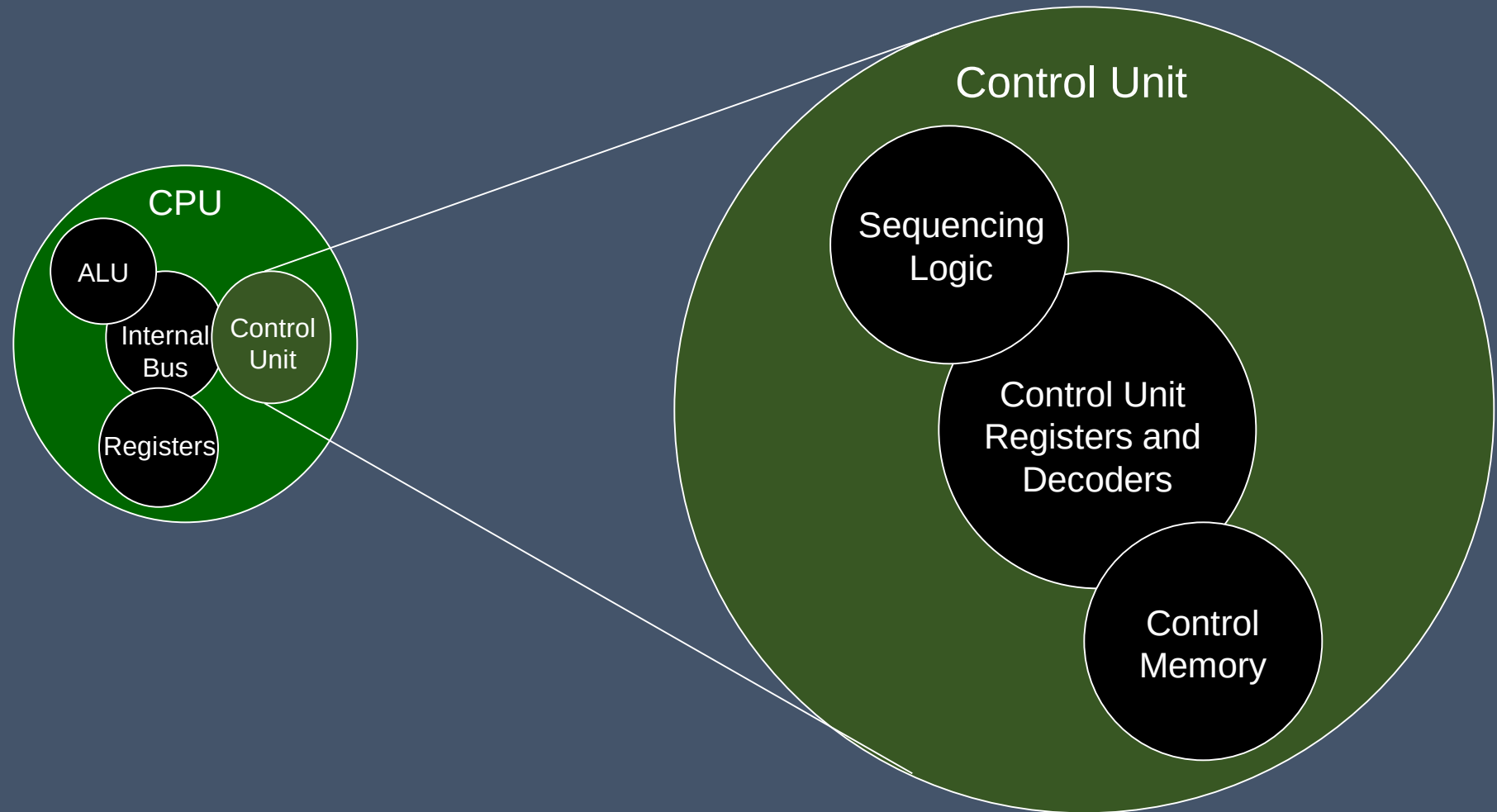


Structure The CPU

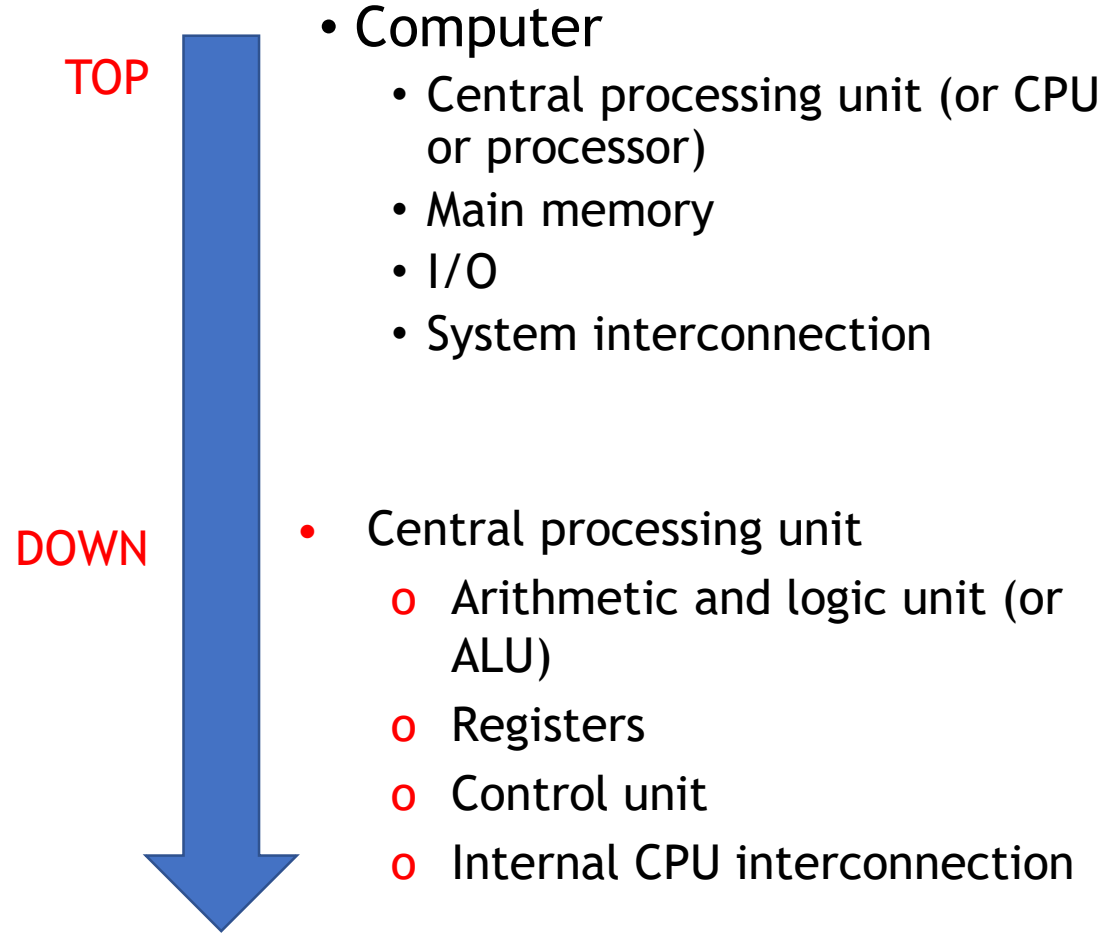


Structure

The Control Unit



Structure

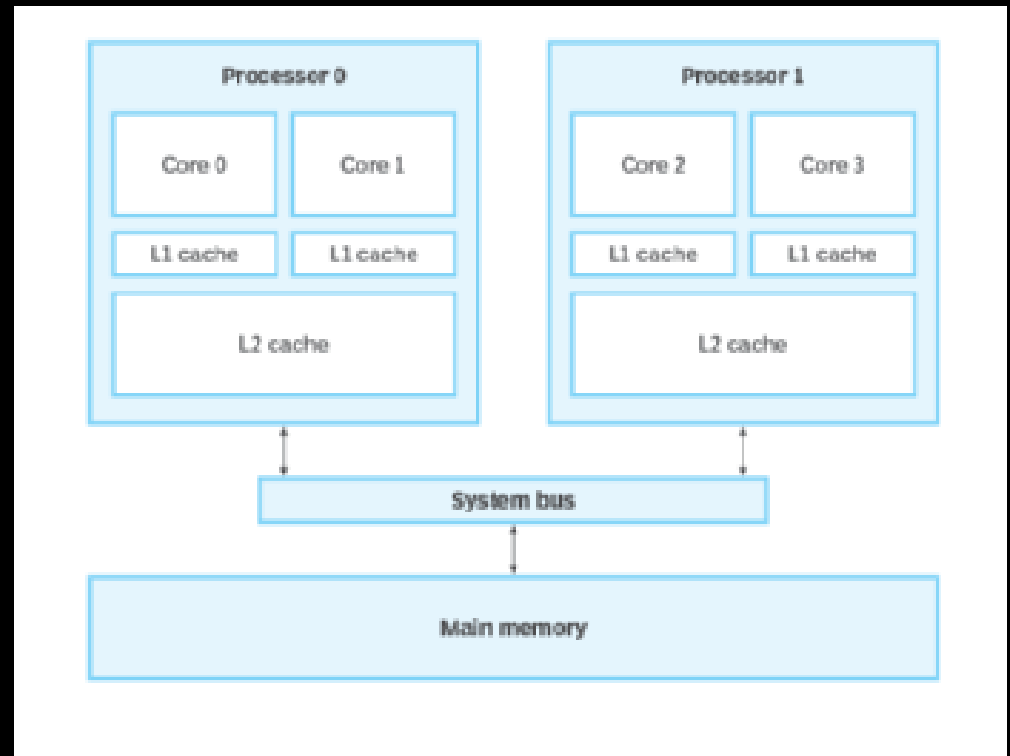


What can you notice?



Multicore Computer Structure

- Contemporary computers generally have multiple processors
- When these processors all reside on a single chip, the term multicore computer is used, and each processing unit (consisting of a control unit, ALU, registers, and perhaps cache) is called a core



Multicore Computer Structure

Terminology

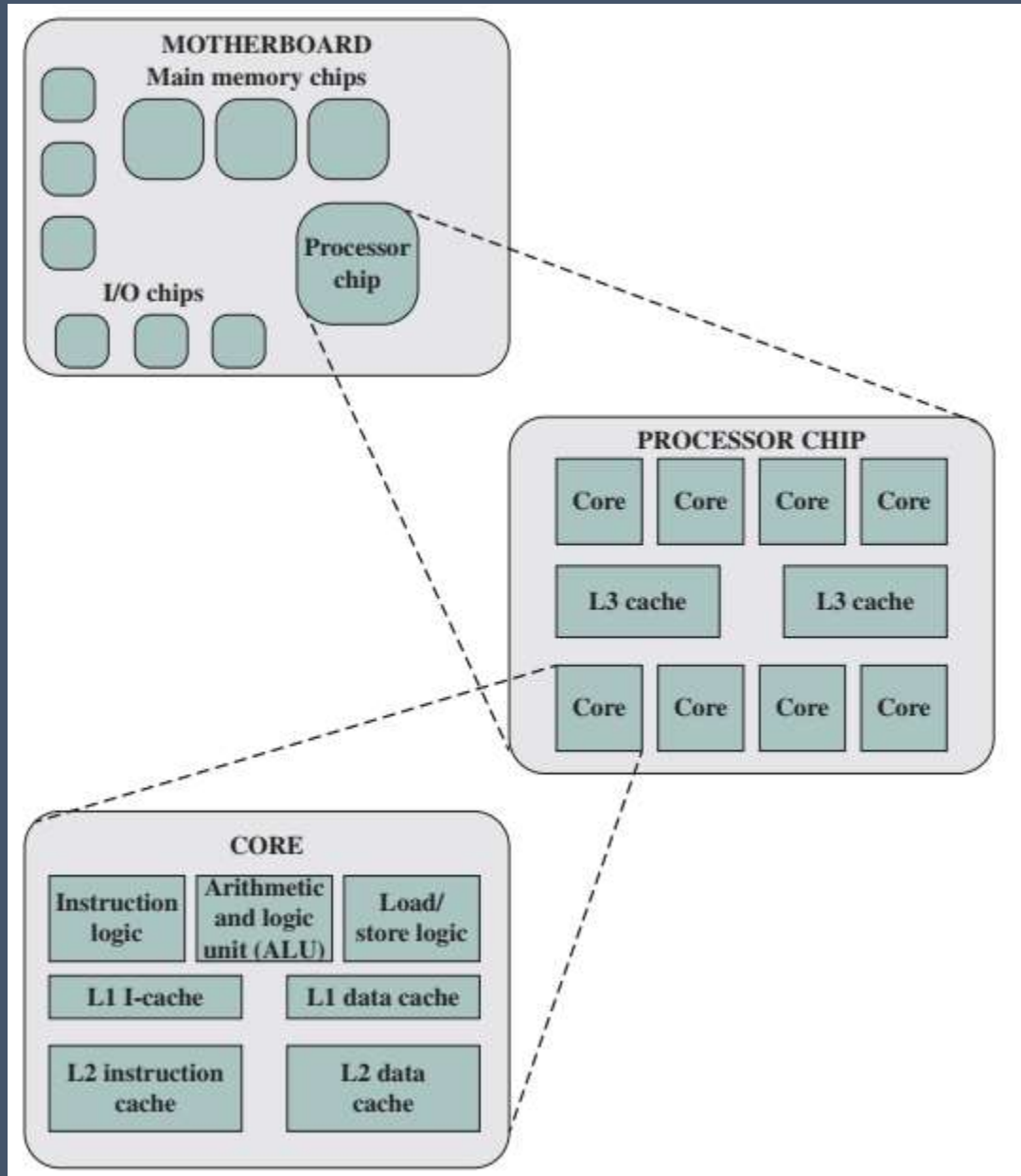
- Central processing unit (CPU)
 - **Fetches and executes instructions**
 - Consists of an ALU, a control unit, and registers
 - Referred to as a processor in a system with a single processing unit
- Core
 - An **individual processing unit** on a processor chip
 - May be equivalent in functionality to a CPU on a single-CPU system
 - Specialized processing units are also referred to as cores

Multicore Computer Structure

Terminology

- Processor
 - Containing **one or more cores**
 - Interprets and executes instructions
 - Referred to as a multicore processor if it contains multiple cores

Multicore Computer Structure



Reflection...

From the lecture today,
I learnt...

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